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Intermittent Fasting & Autophagy

CATEGORY: FASTING PHYSIOLOGY & CELLULAR CLEANSING

"A Scientific Guide to Harnessing Fasting for Longevity, Cellular Regeneration & Effortless Weight Balance"

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Executive Clinical Summary:

Our ancestors never had access to 24-hour convenience stores or constant grazing. Human genes evolved to thrive in cycles of feast and famine. When you give your digestive tract a purposeful rest, your cells initiate profound self-cleansing mechanisms that reduce systemic inflammation and sharpen mental clarity.

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Chapter 1: The Autophagy Timeline & Cellular Recycling

Autophagy (literally 'self-eating') is your cells' built-in quality control system. Damaged mitochondria, misfolded proteins, and intracellular pathogens are encapsulated in autophagosomes and fused with lysosomes for recycling into fresh amino acids. This process ramps up significantly after 14 to 16 hours of continuous fasting as intracellular mTOR is down-regulated and AMPK is activated.

Key Action Steps & Biomarkers:

- 12 Hours: Glycogen stores deplete; ketogenesis begins.
- 14-16 Hours: Autophagy increases by 50-80%; insulin levels reach baseline.
- 18-24 Hours: Peak cellular rejuvenation and BDNF (Brain-Derived Neurotrophic Factor) release.
- Hydration with sodium and potassium prevents 'keto flu' and fasting headaches.

Ø=Ü¡ Clinical Pearl: If you feel hungry at hour 14, remember that ghrelin pulses in waves and usually subsides within 20 minutes. Drink 300ml of warm green tea or black coffee.

Chapter 2: Female Fasting Protocol & Hormone Synchronization

Women are biologically more sensitive to nutrient deprivation. In the luteal phase (the 7 to 10 days leading up to menstruation), progesterone production requires adequate carbohydrate availability and reduced stress signaling. Prolonged fasting during this week can elevate cortisol and disrupt menstrual regularity.

Key Action Steps & Biomarkers:

- Follicular Phase (Days 1-14): Great tolerance for 16:8 fasting and high-intensity exercise.
- Luteal Phase (Days 15-28): Shift to a gentler 12:12 or 14:10 fasting window.
- Incorporate complex starchy tubers (sweet potatoes, squash) during the pre-menstrual week.

Ø=Ü¡ Clinical Pearl: Listen to your body. Fasting is a hormetic tool, not a punishment. Never fast through intense dizziness or heart palpitations.

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[Step 4] Fast 3 hours before bed to maximize growth hormone release during sleep.

[Step 3] Break fast with bone broth, eggs, avocado — avoid heavy carbs first.

Hydrate with 2.5L water + electrolytes during fasting window.

Dr. Arif's Clinical Implementation Blueprint

' VERIFIED MEDICAL PROTOCOL BY DR. ARIF CHOWDHURY

Clinical Conclusion:

Intermittent fasting is one of the most cost-effective, clinically validated tools to reclaim metabolic freedom and promote longevity.

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